

KAN VATAN

BLOOD AT THE ROOTS

a pilot for an original series

written by

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Olive trees rule the rocky hillside.

For a thousand years, they've grown together. Roots sharing resources. Branches interweaving and joining over time.

These are the natural gods of the land.

But black spots mark their green leaves.

SUPER:

HATAY PROVINCE - 2013

CRUNCH

of dead brown leaves under bare feet.

DAVUT (70s) stumbles down the hill from a stone farmhouse. Terrified. Huffing and puffing. Body stronger than mind. Cutting his unprotected soles on the rocky ground.

It's barely dawn. Still dark enough to hide in the trees...

...from chasing FOOTSTEPS...

...which slow nearby.

Davut holds his breath. Grips a SHARP BRANCH. Listens for the steps as a--

HAND GRABS his shoulder from behind.

Davut swings and STABS at--

SEZEN (O.S.)

Baba. It's--

SEZEN (30). Just missing her neck.

SEZEN (CONT'D)

--me.

His fear becomes confusion...then embarrassment as he recognizes his daughter. They speak in **Turkish (bold)**.

DAVUT

Someone was chasing me.

She pats her father's back: *sure, baba*. Takes his arm and leads him up the hill...

...his bare feet trailing RED BLOOD in the dirt.

MATCH CUT TO:

RED MUD

under hiking boots 30km south.

EXT. SYRIAN BORDER - DAY

A backpacker (30s) stops at a mountain vista.

Inhales clear air. Bends to pick stems of wild yarrow,
revealing a THICK SCAR on his neck.

He wraps the flowers in a cloth. Wipes his muddy hands on his
cargo pants, grabs his backpack...

...and walks down the mountain path.

SUPER:

YAYLADAĞI CROSSING
TURKISH-SYRIAN BORDER

A SHRIEK pierces the sky.

He stops. Turns toward the sound.

A JACKAL

bleeds in the forest.

The backpacker approaches, low and slow.

The jackal SNAPS at him. But drops its head, exhausted.

The backpacker slowly touches the Jackal's back. Its eyes
relax. A moment of peace.

And then he finds the wound. A bullet hole.

Shit.

A BULLET wizzes above them.

The backpacker drops flat. Next to the Jackal. Eye to eye.
They breathe together as--

MEN SHOUT through the trees.

The backpacker jumps to his feet--

Sprints through dense pines. About to get away until he--

TRIPS over a root and--

SMACKS his skull on a tree.
Vision blurs. When he looks up--
RIFLES point down.

CUT TO:

TWO HUNTERS

drag the jackal through the trees...
...and the backpacker. Mouth and hands bound with rope.
Ahead: a third hunter dumps wood into a FIRE-PIT.
BLACK SMOKE rises.

MATCH CUT TO:

BLACK SMOKE

on a monitor.

INT. TURKISH JANDARMA - SURVEILLANCE ROOM - SAME

REVEAL a DRONE PILOT watching the black smoke ahead.
He flies the drone toward the fire-pit. Below, he sees:
Hunters dragging a jackal...
...and a backpacker, mouth and hands bound.

DRONE PILOT
Commander?

EXT. SYRIAN BORDER - SAME

The hunters throw the backpacker down against the fire-pit.
He feels heat on his back. Flames lick at his bound wrists.
One hunters digs through his bag. Finds: water purification
tablets. A compass. The yarrow wrapped in cloth. A well-worn
PHRASEBOOK - Arabic, Turkish, Kurdish.

DRONE PILOT (PRE-LAP)
**Looks like a hippie got lost on the
wrong side of the mountain.**

INT. TURKISH JANDARMA - SURVEILLANCE ROOM - SAME

A COMMANDER looks over the Pilot's shoulder, drinking tea.

DRONE PILOT (CONT'D)
Must be some kind of European.

COMMANDER
 (sigh, sipping tea)
May God protect him.

The Commander turns to leave but--

DRONE PILOT
Wait.

The Pilot looks closer at the monitor:

The backpacker is standing.

No ropes on his wrist or ankles.

The hunters finally notice. Then--

Monitor fills with sudden movement.

Too fast to follow. Smoke clouding the image.

COMMANDER
Pull back!

WIDER SHOT

Stillness. All three hunters on the ground. Not moving.

Fire burning. No sign of the backpacker.

EXT. SYRIAN BORDER - SAME

The backpacker runs down the mountain. Panicked.

He turns back to look at the drone and--

SLICES his arm against a jagged pine tree.

But he keeps running into the forest.

Blood drips off his arm...

...onto the gnarled roots.

TITLE:

KAN VATAN
BLOOD AT THE ROOTS

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - DAWN

Boots CRUNCH dead leaves.

Sezen walks into the grove, where:

MUSA (15, skinny as a cypress) inspects a fissure in the bark. It's dark and soft inside.

SEZEN
Günaydın.

He looks up. What? She points to the rising sun.

SEZEN
Morning.

MUSA
(nod)
Sabah.

She nods back. *Sabah*. They're learning. She bends next to him, sees he's looking at the black spots on the leaves.

She takes one in her hands - it crumbles immediately.

MUSA
Mayyit. Dead.

Musa switches back to *Arabic (italic)*.

MUSA
These need water.

She stares at the trees. Replies in **Turkish (still bold)**.

SEZEN
I know.

CUT TO:

HOSES

unrolling from an equipment shed.

Musa drags them to the worst trees. Sezen repositions them along grooves of the roots. He watches carefully.

She returns to the shed. Turns the valve. Water flows.

INT. YILMAZ FARMHOUSE - KITCHEN - DAWN

WATER FLOWS as Sezen fills a glass. Grabs a big fat fig.

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - CONTINUOUS

She hands a glass of water to Musa.

SEZEN

Drink.

She splits the fig, hands him a half.

He waits until she takes a bite of the fruit, but--

BACK DOOR swings open.

Davut emerges. Dressed for work.

He inhales. Finds his way to the nearest trunk. Touches it.

DAVUT

The sun is kind today.

He looks at the shining sun, as Sezen approaches.

Davut touches her cheek. Gentle. Present.

DAVUT (CONT'D)

**Your mother always said to
appreciate it before it goes away.**

Then something shifts in his face. Smile fades. He walks off into the grove.

DAVUT

I'm late.

SEZEN

(chasing after)

**Baba. The doctor is coming today.
He said to rest until he sees you.**

DAVUT

There is work to be done.

SEZEN

Musa and I are handling it.

Davut stops. Turns to Musa. Musa tries to avoid his gaze.

DAVUT

I don't like his old eyes.

SEZEN
We need his help.

DAVUT
One man is enough for the summer.
(marching off again)
Help comes for harvest. That's how
it's worked for seven generations.

SEZEN
But the trees are sick.

DAVUT
What do you know? You're barely
twelve years old.

Davut disappears into the grove...

...leaving Sezen speechless.

DAVUT (O.S.)
Go wake your brother.

She turns back to Musa, who offers his half of the fig.

KAAN (PRE-LAP)
I'm at work.

INT. HEDGE FUND - NIGHT

KAAN (32) sits before MONITORS FLASHING with financial data.
Talking to Sezen.

SEZEN (PHONE)
It's 10pm there.

Outside, the Manhattan skyline twinkles.

KAAN
11. But Peter's on the warpath.
He's about to fire my new analyst.

Kaan peeks into an office, boss PETER yells at young JIMMY.

INT. YILMAZ FARMHOUSE - KITCHEN - DAY

Sezen CHOPS vegetables, phone pinched to ear.

KAAN (PHONE) (CONT'D)
Kid barely made it a week.

She makes a sarcastic face. He somehow knows.

KAAN (PHONE)
Sezen. This is serious.

SEZEN
**This is serious. There's something
wrong with our trees.**

Sezen looks into the living room: Davut watches TV. Loudly.
But she speaks in English, just in case.

SEZEN (CONT'D)
And Baba thinks I'm a 12 year old.

She slips outside.

EXT. YILMAZ FARMHOUSE - CONTINUOUS

Sezen walks into gusting wind. Rattling the leaves.

KAAN (PHONE)
He's just old fashioned.

SEZEN
No, Kaan--

But she hears him talking to someone else.

SEZEN
Kaan!

INT. HEDGE FUND - NIGHT

Kaan quickly finishes his conversation with a colleague and
returns to his conversation.

KAAN
Just tell me what you need.

SEZEN (PHONE)
HELP!

This is loud. He sneaks to the window.

KAAN
Relax. I can pay someone--

SEZEN (PHONE)
Money doesn't solve everything.

Another colleague passes. Kaan pretends it's a business call:

KAAN

It has a pretty high hit rate.

No response. Kaan hears to the wind whipping through his family's trees. It settles him. He switches back to Turkish:

KAAN

Listen. I'll find a maid. Or a nurse. Or a nurse who cleans.

SEZEN (PHONE)

He already has one of those.

CALL ENDS.

Kaan holds the phone for a beat. Stares at it. Then sees:

Jimmy race out of Peter's office. Face red.

BATHROOM

Kaan finds Jimmy's shoes under the stall door.

KAAN

Jimmy? What happened in there?

JIMMY (O.S.)

I'm a fucking idiot.

Kaan leans on a sink. Impatient. Forces a Big Brother tone.

KAAN

You're not a *fucking idiot*.

(sigh)

Just tell me what Peter said.

JIMMY (O.S.)

That my pitch would make good fertilizer.

KAAN

What?

STALL

Jimmy's on the toilet, not using it. Wallowing in self-pity.

JIMMY

Because it's dogshit.

KAAN (O.S.)

No. Jimmy.

Kaan suddenly appears over the stall door.

KAAN (CONT'D)
I mean why are you pitching Peter?

JIMMY
Oh. Um. Navroz said I should tell
him about the chicken--

KAAN
Chicken?
(groaning)
God damnit, dude.

BACK TO BATHROOM

Kaan bangs the stall door in frustration.

KAAN (CONT'D)
I shut down chicken for a reason.
Nav is trying to get you fired.

JIMMY (O.S.)
I don't understand. It's a real
opportunity. This bird flu is
crazy. The CDC says--

KAAN
Exactly, "*the CDC says*". You're not
the only one who can read. And this
isn't fucking Fidelity.

Kaan tries to settle. Be reasonable. He washes his hands.

KAAN
Listen. I know you're new to this.
But we make money by betting
against consensus. We have to know
what others don't.

Jimmy opens the stall door. Nervous. Whispers:

JIMMY
And that's like...okay?

KAAN
What are you saying?

JIMMY
Nothing--

KAAN
Then say nothing.

Kaan closes the stall door on his face. Mutters:

KAAN
Fucking idiot.

Then marches out to the:

HALLWAY

and right into Peter - who checks his watch.

PETER
Seven minutes in the bathroom. Are
you eating our fiber snacks?

Kaan nods slowly.

PETER (CONT'D)
Good. Because things are getting
clogged up around here. I promised
the partners I'd clear some space.

KAAN
Jimmy has potential--

PETER
Jimmy is cheap. Relatively.

He claps Kaan's shoulder. Hard. Unimpressed by the muscles.

PETER
Find me something good, Kaan.
(squeeze)
Before I find someone better.

PRE-LAP: SNAP

EXT. SYRIAN BORDER - DAY

BOOTS SNAP twigs as the backpacker runs down the mountain.
He hides in a group of pine trees. Catches breath. Listens.
Doesn't hear anything. Grabs a cell phone from his bag.
CLIPS open his belt buckle. Pulls out a HIDDEN SIM CARD.
Slots it in the phone. SCREEN LIGHTS UP.
He dials...

This is ABE. But for now, he's known as:

MARCY (PHONE)
Coyote. You're late.

ABE
 I was making friends.

MARCY (PHONE)
 I know.

ABE
 Civilians I think. Just some
 hunters by the border.

CRACKING SOUND

MARCY (PHONE)
 I know.

ABE
 But there were other eyes.

INT. CIA FIELD OFFICE - LOCATION UNDISCLOSED - SAME

CRACK goes a pistachio between razor sharp teeth.

MARCY (O.S.)
 Coyote. I know.

The piercing eyes of MARCY (AKA SNAPPER, height: 4'11") watch
tapped Turkish drone footage from the jandarma station.

MARCY (CONT'D)
 The drone belongs to border
 control. They've already alerted
 Turkish intelligence.

PRE-LAP: ENGINE ROARS

EXT. HATAY PROVINCE - DAY

A government issued sedan drives to the border station.

MARCY (V.O.) (CONT'D)
 MIT Inspector Mehmet Demir is on
 his way there now.

EXT. TURKISH JANDARMA - GATE - DAY

MEHMET DEMIR (55, rumpled suit) hands over his badge,
 revealing a missing ring finger on his left hand.

ABE (V.O.)
You know him?

MARCY (V.O.)
Not yet.

The badge reads: MIT - Counterterrorism.

INT. CIA FIELD OFFICE - LOCATION UNDISCLOSED - SAME

Marcy jumps down from her chair.

MARCY (CONT'D)
But let me worry about the Turks.
Just find Brando. And remember:
this isn't Anbar. If you get taken,
we can't ask for you back.

A long silence.

ABE (PHONE)
I know.

EXT. SYRIAN BORDER - DAY

Abe hangs up.

Pulls out the SIM card. Heads down the mountain.

EXT. SYRIAN HIGHWAY - DAY

The road is cracked. The buildings are empty. The orchards are burned. Like humanity has been stripped from the land.

A white AID TRUCK rumbles down the bombed-out highway.
HUMANITARIAN RELIEF INTERNATIONAL in Arabic and English.

PRE-LAP: AMERICAN CLASSIC ROCK

INT./EXT. AID TRUCK - CONTINUOUS

WILL (40, codename: BRANDO) sings with the radio. Driving one-handed. Hawaiian shirt over tactical vest.

He pulls over to the side of the road. Beside the forest.

DOOR OPENS. Abe pokes his head in.

ABE
Brando?

WILL
Just get in the truck.

Abe climbs in.

WILL
And Coyote?

Abe turns. Will hits the gas.

WILL (CONT'D)
Buckle up.

INT. TURKISH JANDARMA - HALLWAY - DAY

Demir marches down the hall with the COMMANDER.

COMMANDER
He doesn't look like a terrorist.

DEMIR
**And what does a terrorist look
like, Commander?**

Demir stops at a door. Turns back to the Commander.

DEMIR (CONT'D)
**It's been three months since
Reyhanlı and we have exactly zero
suspects. We need to be taking all
leads extremely seriously.**

The Commander's intimidated, but also offended.

COMMANDER
**Of course, Inspector. We are taking
this extremely seriously.**

He opens the door to the:

SURVEILLANCE ROOM

where SOLDIERS are hooting and hollering. Watching:

DRONE FOOTAGE of Abe taking down the Hunters at the border.

DRONE PILOT
Wait. This is my favorite part!

Demir sees on the monitor:

Abe swiftly disarming each of the hunters. Then escaping.

SOLDIER
Play it again!

COMMANDER
That's enough!

DEMIR
Do it.

Pilot looks at the Commander, who nods. He plays the footage.

Demir rubs his missing ring finger as he watches Abe's precise motions. Notices the scar on Abe's neck.

SMASH CUT TO:

INT./EXT. AID TRUCK - DAY

The scar on Abe's neck...below ABE'S NERVOUS FACE.

He clutches the door handle as Will drives. Fast. 160 km/h.

WILL
You unclench your asshole. I only
get paid if I send you back alive.

ABE
You sure you can promise that?

WILL
Of course. I feed people. And no
one kills the bread man.

EXPLOSION in the distance. Abe swings to look.

WILL
Just breathe.
(demonstrating)
In for four. Hold for four.
Out for four. Hold for four. Do it.

Hesitant, Abe tries it. *In, hold, out, hold.* It helps. Abe's heartrate slows down.

Will pulls the truck to the side of the road.

ABE
What's going on?

WILL
Coyote. What'd I just tell you?

RIFLES ON THE WINDOWS

WILL (CONT'D)
Breathe.

Armed men surround the car.

Without looking, Will puts down the window.

WILL
Salam alaykum.

CUT TO:

AID TRUCK

driving away from the checkpoint.

INT./EXT. AID TRUCK - DAY

Abe exhales. Didn't realize he was holding his breath.

ABE
You know them?

WILL
I told you. I feed a lot of people.
Including their boss.

ABE
And they're regime.

WILL
They're not your problem. You're
here 48 hours to do one delivery.

ABE
I'm just trying to keep track of
who the good guys and bad guys are.

WILL
Look around, Coyote.

They pass under a bridge where:

DEAD BODIES HANG.

WILL (CONT'D)
The good guys are all dead.

Blood drips onto the truck.

PRE-LAP: EXPLOSIONS

ACT II**INT. YILMAZ FARMHOUSE - LIVING ROOM - DAY**

REVEAL news from Syria on TV. Bombings. Refugees.

DAVUT (O.S.)
He's worse than his father.

A DOCTOR (50s) examines Davut on the sofa.

DOCTOR
Can you turn that down?

Davut doesn't hear. Doctor grabs a remote. Turns off the TV. Then puts his hand on Davut's leg. Deep breath.

DOCTOR
**Davut Bey. You need rest. At least
until we know more. Let Sezen
handle the grove until harvest.**

KITCHEN

Sezen chops vegetables. Listening.

DAVUT (O.S.)
This is no job for a silly girl.

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - DAY

Sezen finds Musa crouched by the irrigation line. Wrapping a CRACKED HOSE with cloth. Water seeps through anyway.

SEZEN
The Karadağs have a spare hose.

MUSA
No. I fix.

He keeps wrapping. But she's already walking to the:

KARADAĞ FARM

next door. Sezen climbs over the fence.

Notices a WHITE RENTAL CAR in the driveway. City plates.

She continues toward the farmhouse. Hears VOICES. Raised. Around back, she finds:

AHMET KARADAĞ (60s, weathered) blocking ROB (late 20s, safari hat with flaps, sweating through his shirt).

Rob holds SOIL SAMPLES. Trying to explain in broken Turkish:

ROB
Ağaçlar...hasta. Ben... yardım?

AHMET
Get off my land.

SEZEN
Ahmet Bey. What's the problem?

AHMET
This American won't leave me alone.

Sezen looks at Rob. The hat. The tubes. The sweat stains.

SEZEN
You're American?

ROB
You speak English?

SEZEN
(back to Ahmet)
What does he want?

AHMET
**He says there's something wrong
with our trees.**

ROB
There is something wrong. Do you
live nearby?

SEZEN
Next door.

ROB
So you've gotten our letters?

Sezen squints. *What is he talking about?*

ROB
I'm a researcher for an American
company called Terrasource. We're
offering our help to all the farms
in the area. We think our product
can save your trees.

SEZEN
From what?

Rob squints. *She really doesn't know?*

SEZEN (PRE-LAP)
It's a blight.

INT. YILMAZ FARMHOUSE - KITCHEN - DAY

Sezen digs through the trash, phone to ear.

SEZEN (CONT'D)
I knew something was wrong. Rob
says it's all over Hatay.

KAAN (PHONE)
Who's Rob?

SEZEN
The researcher. Are you even
listening to me?

KAAN (PHONE)
Of course I'm listening.

INT. HEDGE FUND - NIGHT

Kaan is not listening. He's researching chicken prices.

KAAN
I mean what are his qualifications?
(quietly clicking)
It just sounds like this guy is
selling snake oil.

SEZEN (PHONE)
He's working with a big American
company. You might know them.

INT. YILMAZ FARMHOUSE - KITCHEN - DAY

In the trash, Sezen crumpled envelopes. TERRASOURCE logo.

SEZEN (CONT'D)
Terrasource?

KAAN (PHONE)
That's a serious firm. What the
fuck are they doing in Hatay?

SEZEN
I told you. They have a cure. For
the blight.

SEZEN (CONT'D)
Some genetically modified rootstock
from Spain. You're not listening.

INT. HEDGE FUND - NIGHT

But Kaan is definitely listening now. On his monitors:
Terrasource stock chart. Research on olive tree blights.

SEZEN (PHONE)
Kaan?

Kaan squints at the market cap data. Peeks at Peter's office.

KAAN
Sorry. Go ahead.

SEZEN (PHONE)
They need partners in the area to
prove it works. Rob's bringing
samples tomorrow.

KAAN
What. No he's not.

INT. YILMAZ FARMHOUSE - KITCHEN - DAY

Sezen DOES NOT like this tone.

SEZEN
Excuse me?

KAAN (PHONE)
Baba isn't going to let you plant
foreign genetically-engineered
monstrosities in the grove.

SEZEN
Well Baba isn't in charge.

INT. HEDGE FUND - NIGHT

Kaan carefully considers his next move.

KAAN
Sezen. These companies are pirates.
Just let me do some homework. Do
not sign anything. Do not take
anything from them.

Silence. Kaan checks Peter's office again. Grinds his teeth.

KAAN
Sezen? I need you to trust me.

INT. YILMAZ FARMHOUSE - KITCHEN - DAY

Sezen looks out at the dying grove.

SEZEN (PHONE)
Whatever you say, Kaan.

Hangs up. Checks the crumpled letter. Finds the phone number.
Dials it into her phone. Thumb hangs over CALL button...

INT. HEDGE FUND - NIGHT

Kaan puts down the phone. Looks at Peter's office. Thinks.
Then throws a pen at Jimmy.

KAAN
What do you know about olive trees?

CUT TO:

OLIVE TREES

emerge on the horizon.

INT./EXT. AID TRUCK - DAY

REVEAL Will and Abe driving on a dusty, busted highway. In
the distance, Abe sees green hills. Beautiful.

INT. WILL'S COMPOUND - DAY

LEYLA (22) CHOPS vegetables. Dumps them in the lamb stew.

Dark hair pulled back, moving with nervous efficiency. As she
reaches for spices on a high shelf, we see:

a thick scar wrapped around her ankle. Like a chain.

HEADLIGHTS sweep across the windows. She smoothes her dress.

EXT. WILL'S COMPOUND - DAY

Outside, the aid truck pulls up to a LOW-WALLED COMPOUND.

RAZOR WIRE tops the walls. Security cameras at corners.
Olive groves surround the house, silver-green in sunset.

INT. WILL'S COMPOUND - CONTINUOUS

Abe follows Will inside. There's tile floors, high ceilings, and a big TV. On the table: English language workbooks.

LEYLA (O.S.)
Dinner is one half hour.

Leyla appears in the kitchen doorway. She has a thick accent.

WILL
No "one". Just "half hour".

Will grabs a bottle, nods for Abe to follow him outside.
Leyla studies Abe as he passes.

EXT. WILL'S COMPOUND - OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT

Darkness falls over the olive trees.

WILL
I'm helping with her English. She
says she wants to move to America.

ABE
Where's her family?

WILL
The kid brother fled to Turkey.
Rest of them are prolly dead. If
they're lucky.

Will pours two glasses of Arak. Hands one to Abe.

WILL
They're Yazidi. Religious minority
from the east. The new Jihadis in
town have been rounding them up.

Abe follows Will's eyes back to the kitchen window, where
Leyla's watching. She quickly turns away.

WILL
But she's not theirs anymore.

HOWL from the trees.

Will's hand moves to an electric CATTLE PROD on his belt.

WILL
Fucking jackals.

Abe stares into the dark trees. Silence. His skin gets cold.

WILL
We should get inside.

INT. DEMIR'S OFFICE - NEXT DAY

A small cup of hardened, old Turkish coffee sits on a map of the Turkish-Syrian border.

ELIF (PHONE)
But it's on Saturday. You promised.

ON THE WALL: Evidence of the Reyhani car bombings - surveillance photos, blast sites, faces of victims.

DEMIR (O.S.)
I said I would do my best.

Demir, unshaven, talks on the phone. Rubs his missing finger.

ELIF (PHONE)
Well do better, Baba. This is my graduation.

INT. CIA FIELD OFFICE - UNKNOWN LOCATION - SAME

Marcy quietly eats pistachios as she listens to the call.

DEMIR (V.O.)
And this is my job. Please don't make it harder than it needs to be.

She hears Elif hang up.

INT. DEMIR'S OFFICE - DAY

Demir sighs, puts down the phone. Then pins a photo next to the evidence from the bombings.

Abe's face - from the drone footage.

MATCH CUT TO:

ABE'S FACE

looking out the truck window. To the ocean.

INT./EXT. AID TRUCK - DAY

REVEAL Will and Abe flying down the highway to a PORT.

Blue Mediterranean stretches to the horizon.

Cranes GROAN overhead. Russian military vehicles everywhere.

A FERRY docks ahead. Same HUMANITARIAN RELIEF INTERNATIONAL logo as Will's aid truck.

WILL
Stay in the truck.

EXT. LATAKIA PORT - A LITTLE LATER

RUSSIAN SOLDIERS move crates from ferry to Will's aid truck. Food supplies on top.

Will supervises. Joking with a Russian Officer. Beneath the food: STEEL GLIMMERS in the sunlight.

MARCY (PRE-LAP)
So Brando's behaving himself?

INT. AID TRUCK - CONTINUOUS

Abe watches through the window. Talking to Marcy.

ABE
I thought you trusted him.

MARCY (PHONE)
I trust his incentives. But he's not one of ours.

ABE
Neither am I.

A long beat.

ABE
Just explain how I get out of here tomorrow. Will Turkish intelligence be looking for me at the border?

MARCY (PHONE)
We'll send you the other way.

Abe freezes.

ABE
No. I'm not going back there--

MARCY (PHONE)
We don't have a choice. If you get
picked up--

ABE
I know.
(sigh, fuck)
You can't ask for me back.

LOADING DOCK

Abe gets out of the truck. Heads for a bathroom sign.

A HAND clamps his shoulder from behind. Abe SPINS--

Body coils. Arm cocked. Ready to strike--

A YOUNG RUSSIAN SOLDIER. Barely twenty. Confused.

WILL (O.S.)
Easy.

Will appears. Hand on Abe's shoulder. Smiles at the soldier.

INT./EXT. AID TRUCK - DAY

Will and Abe get in. DOORS SLAM.

WILL
I said stay in the truck.

ABE
I have to piss.

WILL
(starting engine)
And I have to keep you alive.

INT. LATAKIA PORT - SURVEILLANCE ROOM - SAME

A RUSSIAN SOLDIER watches the truck drive away. Then checks the security footage. Rewind to Abe's near-fight. He pauses on Abe's face. Picks up a phone.

INT. WILL'S COMPOUND - DAY

The house is silent. Leyla clears breakfast plates.

Then sits with her English textbooks. Opens one, revealing:

Hidden photos. Faded. A family. Parents. Younger siblings. Everyone smiling. And a map. Their location in Syria circled. With a line that goes across the border...

JIMMY (PRE-LAP)
It's a trail of death.

...to Hatay Province.

MATCH CUT TO:

INT. HEDGE FUND OFFICE - CONFERENCE ROOM - NIGHT

Jimmy shows Kaan SATELLITE IMAGES of Hatay Province. Black canopies spreading across the region like a plague.

JIMMY (CONT'D)
I tracked social media complaints
about dying trees and matched them
to satellite imaging.

Kaan's mouth moves with concern, then excitement.

ROB (PRE-LAP)
It's spreading from the border.

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - DAY

Rob and Sezen examine blackened leaves.

ROB (CONT'D)
These strains are what, 500 years
old? A thousand? They have no
resistance to something like this.

SEZEN
So? What can we do?

JIMMY (PRE-LAP)
Terrasource has already developed
disease-resistant cultivars in
Spain and Greece.

INT. HEDGE FUND OFFICE - CONFERENCE ROOM - NIGHT

Kaan leans forward, tapping his feet.

JIMMY (CONT'D)
No public info on Turkey.

KAAN

But?

JIMMY

(little smirk)

But...

Jimmy flips a laptop. A press release from the Penn State Department of Plant Science. Terrasource logo.

"Exploring foreign scion integration with endemic rootstock."

JIMMY

They're definitely up to something.

Kaan scans the photo of researchers in a lab. And then sees in the caption: ROB GREEN, PhD CANDIDATE.

His feet stop tapping.

SEZEN (PRE-LAP)

Will this actually work?

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - DAY

Sezen looks up at the dying canopy of a tree.

ROB

That's what we're here to prove.
I'm hoping you can help.

Rob hands her a tablet with a CONTRACT.

ROB (CONT'D)

Standard NDA. And permission to
collect data on the grafted trees.

Sezen looks up at the house. Davut's light is off.

ROB

Maybe talk to your family first?

SEZEN

(snatching tablet)

I am the family.

Sezen signs the contract.

EXT. SYRIAN HIGHWAY - DAY

Barrel bomb hits a hillside. Smoke plumes rise. The aid truck drives away from the lush coast into the heat of the desert.

INT./EXT. AID TRUCK - CONTINUOUS

Abe stares at the destruction. Will drives, relaxed.

WILL
Worse than Iraq?

Abe squints at him. *How does he know about that?*

WILL
You don't think I did my homework?
(pulling truck over)
Just remember to breathe.

Abe realizes they're at a CHECKPOINT.

Suddenly, the car is surrounded by masked gunmen. GUN BARREL to glass. Will calmly puts the window down.

A GUNMAN peers inside. They speak *in Arabic (italics)*.

WILL
Salam alaykum.

Will tosses a black bag through the window.

GUNMAN
What the fuck is this?

Other gunmen gather around as they pour out the contents.

GUNMAN (CONT'D)
No Kit Kats?

It's all fun-sized American candy bars.

WILL
Bring us in and you get the rest.

The Gunman opens the door. Nods for Abe to scooch.

Abe scooches into the middle. The Gunman climbs in, lifts his mask to his nose, unwraps a Snickers. Chocolate on his breath. Kalashnikov across his lap.

Abe stares straight ahead. Breathes. Will drives into the desert until they reach the:

REBEL COMPOUND

Former school. High walls, but the playground is intact.

A BOY chases a soccer ball past a FIGHTER cleaning his rifle.

The Guard waves them through the gate.

THE TRUCK

is unloaded. Will and Abe help FIGHTERS with CRATES of food. Lentils. Canned goods. Medical supplies.

A desperate looking MOTHER with two children lingers nearby.

Will hands her a heaping bag of rice.

ABE
I'm gonna find the bathroom.

WILL
You really can't wait?

ABE
(walking off)
No.

INT. REBEL COMPOUND - BATHROOM - DAY

FLUSH.

Abe steps back from a tiny urinal. Cartoon fish on the tiles. A faded poster: *WASH YOUR HANDS* in Arabic.

He moves to the sink. Cracked mirror. Water trickles. He splashes his face. Looks at himself. Then walks out into the:

HALLWAY

where children's drawings line the walls. He peeks inside a:

CLASSROOM

and finds old educational posters.

Small desks still in rows. Backpacks on hooks. Like they just left for recess. Then he notices, on the wall:

A FLAG with the Shahada in white Arabic script.

His jaw tightens. The black flag of Jihad. His mind flashes.

He turns to a window. In the courtyard, he sees Will unloading weapons with fighters. Laughing.

Then he hears VOICES from a closet door.

Abe approaches the door. Stops. Listens. Hears:

A CHAIN DRAGGING on the floor.

Puts his hand on the door handle. But doesn't turn.

Then, he hears CRYING inside.

He checks behind him, then opens the door to the:

STORAGE ROOM

and finds YOUNG WOMEN sitting against a wall. Teens, at best.

CHAINED by the ankle to bolts in concrete.

Abe goes pale.

One GIRL meets his eyes just as--

FIGHTER (O.S.)
What are you doing!?

Big FIGHTER fills the doorway. Kalashnikov raised.

The girl scrambles up, chain rattling:

GIRL
He's lost--

The Fighter quickly SMACKS her with the rifle.

She falls down. Bleeding from her chin.

Abe turns to the Fighter. Eye contact.

FIGHTER
I asked you--

Abe STRIKES the Fighter's throat. Precise. Brutal. Out of pure instinct.

The Fighter drops his rifle, clutching his crushed windpipe--

ABE
Fuck.

Abe reaches for the gun but--

ANOTHER RIFLE CRACKS HIM in the back of the skull.

CUT TO BLACK.

ACT III

OVER BLACK:

Labored BREATHING. Something TIGHTENS. A strangled GASP.

CLOSE UP ON: FINGERS clawing at dirt.

WIDER: Hands bound. Not by rope. But by roots.

DAVUT struggles on his back in the grove. The earth swallowing him.

SMOKE rises. The trees are BURNING.

A FIGURE approaches through the haze. Carrying a torch.

DAVUT
Who are you?

SEZEN puts her finger to her lips.

SEZEN
Shh.

Then touches the torch to the roots below Davut. Before they erupt in flame--

SMASH CUT TO:

INT. YILMAZ FARMHOUSE - DAVUT'S BEDROOM - DAY

DAVUT wakes from the nightmare. Covered in sweat.

Sezen's waiting beside him. Concerned.

SEZEN
Baba. I'm here. Are you okay?

He looks into her eyes. Still half in the nightmare.

SEZEN
I should call the doctor--

He grips her wrist. Hard. Then releases. Tries to rise.

DAVUT
I'm fine. I have work to do--

SEZEN
Please. You'll hurt yourself.

She presses him back down.

SEZEN (CONT'D)
I'll take care of everything today.

He looks in her eyes. Then shakes off the dream.

DAVUT
Thank you.

She squints at his pale face. Surprised to see clarity for the first time in a while.

DAVUT
**I know I am...like vinegar. It is
hard being trapped inside my mind.**
(pained breath)
All I see is death.

He manages to lift a shaky hand, touching her arm.

SEZEN
I know, Baba.

PRE-LAP: STRAINED BREATHING

DAVUT
I hope you don't.

INT. REBEL COMPOUND - CLASSROOM - DAY

Abe is bound and gagged. Bloody crack on his head.

A REBEL ties his hands tight just as Will storms in.

WILL
What is this?

REBEL
You can't be in here.

Will pulls out a handgun.

WILL
Didn't your commander tell you?

Will BASHES the Rebel over the head with the gun.

WILL
I'm the god damn breadman.

Will pulls Abe off the floor.

CUT TO:

INT./EXT. AID TRUCK - DAY

Will puts Abe in the truck. Gets in driver's seat.

WILL

Fucking idiot. Do you know what the market is like for Americans here?

Will starts the engine.

WILL

Especially with your record.

Abe stays silent for a beat. Then--

ABE

Did you know?

Will drives. Ignoring the question.

ABE

Did. You. Know.

Will glances at him. Then back to the road. Exhales.

ABE

Are they al-Qaeda?

WILL

Not anymore.

Abe groans. Before he can explode--

WILL

We don't choose our friends out here. We choose our enemies.

(beat)

And a choice has finally been made. That's why they sent you.

ABE

Is it?

Will gives him a look. What?

ABE

You could have done this yourself. So what am I? Insurance?

Will thinks for a moment. No use lying.

WILL

More like...a proof of concept.

ABE
That fucking bitch--

WILL
Settle down. It would be
irresponsible to use their own.
That's what makes us useful.

ABE
Us?

WILL
I told you. I feed everyone. That's
why I'm still alive. That's how
you're still alive.

Abe looks out the window. A burnt orchard.

PETER (PRE-LAP)
Does this look like a charity?

INT. HEDGE FUND - PETER'S OFFICE - DAY

Peter does pull-ups on a bar. First thing in the morning.

KAAN (O.S.)
Of course not. But this is an
opportunity. A real one.

Kaan and Jimmy sit in chairs, pitching.

KAAN (CONT'D)
This disease is wrecking acres of
profitable land as we speak. And
nobody else with Terrasource's
capabilities is even present in the
region. Whatever they have, they're
years ahead of the competition.

Peter hops off the bar. Thinking.

PETER
No offense, Kaan. But how is Turkey
moving the needle for a
multinational like Terrasource?

KAAN
There are sixty million olive trees
in Hatay province alone. And the
blight creates concentrated demand.
If we get the timing right with
short-dated calls before the panic
starts, a bump is a windfall.

Peter flops down behind his desk.

PETER
You sound remarkably certain.

Kaan exchanges an excited glance with Jimmy. An opening.

KAAN
My family lives out there. They've
seen the blight themselves.

PETER
Fuck your family, Kaan. I'm talking
about Terrasource. How do you know
they have a market ready solution?

Kaan considers his response. Peter assesses him. Then:

PETER
Jimmy.

Jimmy perks up. Kaan shifts in his chair.

PETER
Get us coffee.

JIMMY
I thought you didn't drink caff--

PETER
Get the fuck out.

Jimmy quickly leaves the room. Peter leans into Kaan. So?

KAAN
I have visibility into the rollout.
Do you want me to--

PETER
I want you to silently indicate
that this will not create problems
for the partners.

Kaan gives him a confident head shake. It won't.

PETER
(turning away)
Then pull the trigger. Market open.

KAAN
Tomorrow?

PETER
Is that a problem?

Kaan quickly shakes his head. Peter shoots him a fake smile.

PETER

Then let's save some fucking trees.

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - DAY

Late afternoon light filters through the canopies.

Sezen walks through the grove. Phone to her ear.

SEZEN

I'm busy.

KAAN (PHONE)

I know. I just wanted to tell you:
I looked into Terrasource. And
honestly, I'm impressed. But we
need to be careful. We can't be
test rabbits.

Sezen stops at a diseased tree.

SEZEN

We're running out of time.

INT. HEDGE FUND - SAME

Kaan peeks into Peter's office.

KAAN (CONT'D)

I know that. I do. But these R&D
contracts are complicated. One bad
clause and they own everything that
grows on our soil. Forever.

SEZEN (PHONE)

I'm not an idiot, Kaan.

KAAN

Of course not. And that's why you
know you have to be patient.

He steps toward the windows, speaking quiet:

KAAN

Listen. I can come home next month.
We'll look over everything. We can
even meet with them together.

SEZEN (PHONE)

You're coming home?

KAAN
Isn't that what you want?

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - DAY

Sezen leans against a tree.

SEZEN
I'm handling things on my own.

KAAN (PHONE)
But you don't have to.

She looks out at the quiet grove.

KAAN (PHONE)
And I know I don't say it enough,
but thank you for keeping it all
together. I just want to
contribute. The best way I can.

INT. HEDGE FUND - DAY

Kaan bites his lip. Waiting. Getting nothing.

KAAN (CONT'D)
Just don't take anything from them.
And definitely don't sign anything.
We'll do this as a family.

Kaan waits. The silence is painful.

SEZEN (PHONE)
Okay, Kaan. I'll see you soon.

Kaan exhales.

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - DAY

Sezen hangs up. Thinks for a moment.

ROB (O.S.)
Everything okay?

Rob's on a ladder. Musa steadies it below.

SEZEN
You tell me.

ROB
Well. This one's clearly infected.

Rob cuts a diseased branch. Hands it to her. Dark and soft. Then makes a careful incision on the exposed surface.

ROB
Can you ask Musa to pass me the
scion wood?

Musa grabs a branch, wrapped in plastic. Hands it to Rob.

SEZEN
He knows some English.

MUSA
My sister. Teach.

Rob smirks. Sezen does too.

SEZEN
What happens now? Replace the top?

ROB
Not replacing. *Joining*. The trees
come and go. But the roots are
basically immortal.

Rob slides the scion wood into the incision on the tree.

ROB
We're just giving them the best of
what the foreign stock have to
offer so they can battle the
disease and can keep growing.

He tapes around the graft. Pulls it tight.

MATCH CUT TO:

THREAD pulls tight--

INT. WILL'S COMPOUND - NIGHT

--through the gash in Abe's scalp.

Dried blood caked in his hair from the rebel's rifle.

WILL
Don't be so hard on yourself.

Will ties off a suture. Leyla watches from the doorway.

WILL (CONT'D)
Most people can't survive here.

ABE
You seem okay.

WILL
I adapt to the ecosystem.

Will's phone BUZZES. He ignores it. Starts another suture.

WILL (CONT'D)
It's Will by the way.

Abe meets his eyes in the mirror.

WILL
Relax, Coyote.
(smirk)
You don't need to show me yours.

Phone BUZZES again.

Will ties off the last stitch. Barks to Leyla:

WILL
Clean this up. Put on the bandage.

Leyla steps in as Will answers the phone.

WILL
Salam Alaykum.

ABE
Thanks, Leyla.

Will SHUSHES them as he takes the call in the hallway.

LEYLA
What he says?

ABE
What?

Leyla mimics the finger-to-lips gesture.

LEYLA
"Shh".

ABE
Oh. He's just saying be quiet.

She mumbles SHH as she lays the bandage on Abe's head.

LEYLA'S ROOM

Will takes the call inside Leyla's room.

WILL
Sounds good. I'll see you soon.

As he hangs up, something catches his eye--
Her English book. Open on the desk.

ROB (PRE-LAP)
To home.

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT

Moonlight on ancient bark. Fresh white grafts everywhere.

Sezen and Rob sit on a stone wall. Bottle of raki and two glasses. They tap the glasses.

ROB (CONT'D)
Do you ever think about leaving?

SEZEN
I actually did a semester at UT.
Hook 'em.

Rob chuckles at the image.

ROB
Texas. Really? Why'd you leave?

SEZEN
My mom.

She takes a long drink.

SEZEN
Someone had to come back to take
care of him. Of this.

ROB
You have a brother though right?
What's his name?

Sezen looks out at the trees.

SEZEN
He has other priorities.

PRE-LAP: CLINK!

KAAN (PRE-LAP)
To saving the fucking trees.

INT. BAR - DAY

Kaan taps his glass to Jimmy's in a mostly empty bar.

JIMMY
Your trees.

Kaan's glass stops halfway to his mouth. Something lands.

Jimmy doesn't notice. Raises his glass again.

PRE-LAP: SHHH

EXT. WILL'S COMPOUND - GUEST BATHROOM - NIGHT

Reveal the SHOWER running steamy water.

Abe hops in. Careful to avoid his bandaged head.

His scar runs from his throat, across his chest, over his shoulder. Like someone tried to cut him in half.

WILL (PRE-LAP)
I'm so impressed with you.

LEYLA'S ROOM - SAME

Downstairs, Leyla walks in to find the lights on. And:

Will sitting at her desk, looking at her English books.

WILL (CONT'D)
English. What a language. So many words to say the same thing. So many meanings for the same words. Like "appreciate".

LEYLA
Thanking.

WILL
Right. But it also means to measure the value of something. Or someone.

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT

Laughter fades. Sezen and Rob look at each other. Close.

WILL (V.O.)(CONT'D)
So when I say "I appreciate you", I
could mean "I am thankful for you".
Or, I could be saying...that I'm
considering your worth.

EXT. WILL'S COMPOUND - LEYLA'S ROOM - NIGHT

Will lifts her English book--

WILL (CONT'D)
And, Leyla - you're worth nothing
to me dead.

The map of Hatay and family photos fall out.

LEYLA
I wasn't--

He ZAPS the cattle prod in his left hand.

WILL
Enough.

She shudders. His eyes flash as he rises.a

WILL
They're gone. All of them.

Tears run over her cheeks.

WILL
I'm the only one who can protect
you now.

He steps closer. Gentle now.

WILL
Do you understand me?

She nods. Defeated. He touches her cheek. Then leaves.

She picks up the family photo from the floor.

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT

Rob reaches for Sezen's hand, but--

BUZZING from his pocket.

ROB
Sorry.

He checks his phone. Rises quickly. Concerned.

ROB
It's the New York office.
(stepping away, answering)
Rob Green.
(listening)
Yes. I'm with her now.

His face drained of color.

ROB
What? What information?

He turns to Sezen. Horrified.

PRE-LAP: DING!

INT. LIMO - NIGHT

Peter gets an email.

RE: TERRASOURCE COMPLIANCE

ROB (V.O.) (CONT'D)
Who's Kaan?

His jaw locks into place.

DEMIR (PRE-LAP)
That's him.

EXT. WILL'S COMPOUND - GUEST BATHROOM - NIGHT

Abe stands under the water. Eyes closed.

DEMIR (PRE-LAP) (CONT'D)
The man from the border.

Abe OPENS his eyes.

MATCH CUT TO:

INT. HATAY HOTEL ROOM - NIGHT

ABE'S FACE in a photo from the port on Demir's laptop.

Now, he can clearly see the SCAR on his neck.

DEMIR (CONT'D)
I need to see him immediately.

Demir crosses the room to a WALL OF PHOTOGRAPHS. Maps. Surveillance photos of the Reyhanlı bombing site. Plus photos of dozens of victims. Faces of the dead.

ON TOP: ABE'S FACE. With the neck scar. From drone footage.

DEMIR (CONT'D)
Do you understand me?

Demir rubs his missing finger. Excited.

DEMIR (CONT'D)
I have to talk to him.

INT. CIA FIELD OFFICE - UNKNOWN LOCATION - SAME

MARCY listens to Demir's conversation.

DEMIR (V.O.) (CONT'D)
Before they torture him to death.

Fuck.

INT. WILL'S COMPOUND - LEYLA'S ROOM - NIGHT

Leyla watches through the window, into the grove, where:

Will tosses the CATTLE PROD.

Then he checks ammo in his handgun. Holsters it. Grabs his phone, makes a call. Mumbles in Arabic.

PRE-LAP: BUZZ BUZZ

GUEST BATHROOM

Abe's phone VIBRATES. He turns off the shower. Answers.

MARCY (PHONE)
Get out.

What?

MARCY (PHONE) (CONT'D)
Syrian Mukhbarrat are on their way.

ABE
Why do you even care? I'm only here
in case something goes wrong.

MARCY (PHONE)
Coyote.

GUEST BEDROOM

Someone steps in, approaches the bathroom door.

MARCY (CONT'D)
Something has gone wrong.

INT. CIA FIELD OFFICE - UNDISCLOSED LOCATION - SAME

Silence on the other line.

MARCY
Coyote?

INT. WILL'S COMPOUND - GUEST BEDROOM - NIGHT

A KNIFE presses into Abe's throat.

MARCY (V.O.)
Coyote are you there?

He drops the phone.

A dot of blood forms on his skin.

LEYLA (O.S.)
Shh.

ACT IV**INT. BAR - NIGHT**

Kaan and Jimmy continue drinking and celebrating when--
Kaan's phone BUZZES on the table. It's Sezen. He smiles.

KAAN
We were just talking about you.

SEZEN (PHONE)
What the fuck did you do?

Kaan double takes, confused. Turns away from Jimmy.

KAAN
What are you talking about?

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT

Rob's rental car pulls away. Taillights disappearing down the dirt road.

SEZEN (O.S.)
Rob got fired. Because of you.

Sezen watches from the grove. Bottle of raki in hand.

SEZEN (CONT'D)
They said he gave you insider information.

INT. BAR - NIGHT

Kaan looks up at Jimmy. Panicked.

KAAN
Sezen. I don't understand.

Just then, JIMMY'S PHONE RINGS.

SEZEN (PHONE)
You will.

It's Peter.

INT. WILL'S COMPOUND - GUEST BEDROOM - NIGHT

Leyla holds the knife at Abe's throat.

LEYLA

The man sells you. Tonight.

Abe studies her eyes. She's not lying.

ABE

He'll kill you for this.

LEYLA

Then take me.

ABE

Then he'll kill us both.

LEYLA

I don't care. I have no one.

Neither does he.

ABE

I can't protect you.

Before she can respond--

WILL (O.S.)

Leyla?

Leyla turns to the door. Then back to Abe, whispering:

LEYLA

Stay.

She heads into the hall.

Abe exhales. Goes to the window. Opens it.

Cool air rushes in. He looks back at the door to the hall.

Then grabs his bag.

BACK DOOR

Leyla finds Will anxious, waiting.

WILL

What's going on up there?

LEYLA

He's scared.

INT. KAAAN'S APARTMENT - MORNING

Kaan storms in.

SLAMS the door. The mirror on the back shakes and he PUNCHES IT. It shatters to the floor.

He grabs his phone. Scrolls to SEZEN.

Then past her name.

INT. YILMAZ FARMHOUSE - DAVUT'S ROOM - NIGHT

Davut's phone sings and glows.

Finally, he rustles awake. Answers:

DAVUT

Kaan?

KAAN (PHONE)

Baba.

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT

Drunk, Sezen stares into the grove.

KAAN (V.O.) (CONT'D)

**Do you know what your daughter has
been doing?**

PRE-LAP: THUMP

EXT. WILL'S COMPOUND - OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT

Abe drops out of the window to the ground. Bag on shoulders.

This is the best chance he'll get.

He heads for the grove, but--

A GUN COCKS behind him.

WILL (O.S.)

Careful. There's jackals out there.

Abe puts his hands up. Will quickly checks for weapons.

WILL

On the ground.

ABE
(kneeling)
Will--

WILL
This isn't on me. I would've vastly
preferred to keep you alive.

Will pulls out ROPES and TAPE.

WILL
You made me choose. This is only
way I can survive. I told you.

Pulls Abe's hands behind his back. And securely ties him up.

WILL
I feed people.

Will TAPES Abe's mouth shut.

INT. YILMAZ FARMHOUSE - DAVUT'S ROOM - NIGHT

Davut sits on the edge of the bed. Phone still in hand.

He stands. Unsteady.

EXT. WILL'S COMPOUND - OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT

Will sets Abe down, mouth taped, against a tree.

WILL
It'll be alright, Coyote.

Tucks his gun in his pants.

WILL (CONT'D)
Just breathe.

ZAP--

Will convulses.

Falls forward. Gun drops to the ground.

LEYLA stands behind him with the cattle prod.

Looks at Abe.

LEYLA
You owe me. Still.

From the ground, Abe sees:

The scar on Leyla's ankle.

LEYLA

Now. Hurry.

She reaches for the gun but--

Will grabs her scarred ankle.

She topples to the ground. Onto sharp fallen branches.

Abe struggles against his restraints. Can't move.

In pain, Will crawls over Leyla.

WILL

I saved your life. Both of you.

Gets on top of her. Straddles her chest. Weight pressing down. She can barely breathe.

WILL (CONT'D)

And this is what I get?

He looks at Abe.

WILL

You think he's going to protect you? He's a fucking war criminal.

Will stares deep into Leyla's eyes.

WILL

It's true. They fished him out of a military prison in Mosul. Someone to burn if things go bad.

Her hand closes around a tree branch.

WILL

He can't protect you. No one can protect you except for me.

RUSTLING in the trees.

Something's there.

Will turns to look.

LEYLA STABS his neck with a branch.

BLOOD spurts from his aorta.

And he falls forward onto Leyla.

His full weight trapping her.

PRE-LAP: CHOPPING

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT

Sezen lifts her head from the bench. Hears:

CHOPPING in the distance.

She follows the sound through the dark trees.

SEZEN

Baba?

CHOPPING getting louder as she finds:

Davut attacking an ancient tree with an axe. Shirt soaked with sweat. Eyes wild.

SEZEN (CONT'D)

Baba, stop--

CRACK. Axe bites into healthy wood.

DAVUT

**Where is it? Where's the foreign
poison you brought into our home?**

He staggers toward another tree. Nearly falls.

EXT. WILL'S COMPOUND - OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT

Leyla trapped under Will's body. Blood dripping onto her face. She struggles to move. Or breathe.

ABE

is still tied up nearby. Mouth taped.

Pulls desperately at the ropes. Can't help.

LEYLA

tries to PUSH Will's body off. Can't. Too heavy.

The weight crushing her lungs. Then she hears:

More RUSTLING in the trees.

ABE

hears it too. His eyes go wide.

He tries to shout through the tape - muffled, useless.

LEYLA

stares at the dark canopy above. But can't turn her head.
Just hears--

PANTING. Getting closer.

HOT BREATH on her head.

She holds perfectly still. Eyes wide with terror.

The JACKAL's face appears above her.

Licking Will's blood.

A DROP lands on her forehead. Warm. Thick.

ABE

watches the jackal LICK blood from Will's neck, then from
Leyla's cheek. She cries.

He pulls harder at the ropes.

LEYLA

sees the Jackal's face inches from hers. Yellow eyes. Teeth
visible. A low GROWL from its throat.

The jackal's ears perk up as--

HEADLIGHTS sweeping through the trees.

ENGINES.

A TRUCK pulls in the driveway.

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT

Davut catches himself on a tree trunk. Breathing hard. Looks
around wildly. Then he sees it.

DAVUT

There.

He lurches toward a tree with fresh grafting tape around the trunk. The foreign scion wood joined to ancient roots.

Then grips the axe tighter. Raises it high and--

CRACK.

The axe splits through the graft joint.

Foreign wood splinters.

SEZEN

Baba. Please. Listen to me--

DAVUT

**Kaan told me everything about the
American. You betrayed your family.**

CRACK. Davut's axe bites deeper into the grafted wood.

EXT. WILL'S COMPOUND - OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT

SYRIAN INTELLIGENCE OFFICERS sweep through the grove.

OFFICER 1

They said he'd be back here.

Their flashlights illuminate row by row...

Getting closer to:

LEYLA

The jackal still looming.

Will's dead body still pinning her to the ground.

ABE

watches both threats. The jackal. The approaching flashlight.

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT

CRACK.

Davut sinks the axe into the foreign wood again.

SEZEN
(crying now)
You're going to kill it.

DAVUT
It's already dead!

He raises the axe again.

Sezen grabs the axe mid-swing.

They struggle. His fevered strength shocking her.

DAVUT
And you are not my daughter.

He SHOVES her hard.

Sezen falls BACKWARD onto the ground.

Davut turns back to the tree. Raises the axe high.

Sezen grabs his ankle.

SEZEN
Baba stop!

Davut's weak body can't compensate--

His HEAD CRACKS against the tree trunk.

A sickening sound.

He staggers back, then COLLAPSES forward onto Sezen.

His full weight TRAPPING HER beneath him.

Blood pours from the front of his head...

...onto her face.

EXT. WILL'S COMPOUND - OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT

The Officers sweep their flashlight over:

LEYLA'S FACE.

Blood-streaked. Trapped. Terrified.

OFFICER 1
What the--

THE JACKAL

launches from the darkness.

BITES an Officer's forearm.

LEYLA

hears the officer SCREAM.

SNARLING. SHOTS FIRED.

OFFICER 1 (O.S.)

Run!

ABE

sees the Officers racing to their truck.

But Leyla remains under Will. Lungs compressed.

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT

Sezen is also trapped under Davut's dead weight.

Blood warm on her face. She tries to push him off. Too heavy. She's injured. Something broken. Maybe her shoulder.

She tries again. Nothing. Alone. No one to help.

Blood pooling beneath them.

Finally, Sezen stops struggling. And closes her eyes.

INTERCUT:

- LEYLA exhales. Lungs crushed.
- SEZEN exhales. Blood in her mouth.
- The TREE above Sezen RUSTLES. Her eyes open.
- LEYLA pushes against Will's body.
- SEZEN pushes against Davut's body.
- LEYLA strains. Face red. Pushes harder.
- SEZEN strains. Gasping. Pushes harder.

- LEYLA DUMPS WILL onto the ground beside her.

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT

Sezen rolls Davut off her.

But she doesn't run. Doesn't stand.

She pulls Davut under her. Breathes into his mouth. Pumps his chest. One. Two. Three.

SEZEN
Come on. Come on.

Breathes again. Pumps. Nothing.

SEZEN
Baba. Please.

Nothing. She stops. Pulls him close across her chest.

SEZEN
Baba.

Blood pools beneath them. Seeping into the roots.

MATCH CUT TO:

EXT. WILL'S COMPOUND - OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT

Blood pooling into Syrian earth from Will's neck.

Leyla on her back beside him. Staring at the sky. Catching her breath.

After a moment, she rises. Finds her way to Abe.

RIPS the tape off his mouth. Ouch.

ABE
(gasping for breath)
Thank you.

She unties his hands. As Abe rises he hears:

PANTING from the trees.

ABE
Leyla.

The jackal emerges from the trees. Limping. Covered in blood.

Leyla backs away, scared.

But Abe approaches. He sees:

A bullet wound in its side.

Eye contact. A moment of peace. He reaches carefully--

The jackal BITES his wrist.

Then limps off into the trees.

Blood drips from Abe's arm...

...into the dirt.

DEMIR (PRE-LAP)

Then where the hell is he?

INT./EXT. DEMIR'S CAR - NIGHT

Demir talks to a CONTACT as he drives through the night.

He gets another call from ELIF. Ignores it. Drives faster.

DEMIR (CONT'D)

I said I need him alive.

INT. CIA FIELD OFFICE - NIGHT

Marcy monitors Demir's call.

CONTACT (PHONE)

That's up to God now.

She tosses the headset.

Then SMACKS the bowl of pistachio shells across the room.

Grabs her phone. Makes another call. Breathes. Nervous.

MARCY (V.O.)

He's gone.

VOICE (PHONE)

And?

Marcy packs up her computer.

VOICE (PHONE)

You knew the risk. He's not ours.
We can't ask for him back.

MARCY
I'm not asking.

She hangs up. Zips her bag.

EXT. WILL'S COMPOUND - OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT

Leyla waits alone. Just her map and photos.

Abe finally returns, with his backpack and another duffel full of supplies (looted from Will's compound).

LEYLA
Where now?

ABE
Your brother.

Leyla shakes her head gravely.

ABE
He's alive.

She stops. Can't speak.

ABE
I swear. Will told me. He's
somewhere in Turkey. I'll take you.
If you know where he was going.

Slowly, she pulls out the map. Fumbles to open it. Shows him.

LEYLA
Hatay.

ABE
Then we better get over the border
before daybreak.

He starts walking toward the dark mountains.

Before she follows, she looks at the family photo.

LEYLA
I'm coming...

Touches her brother's face.

MATCH CUT TO:

MUSA

hides behind a tree.

LEYLA (V.O.) (CONT'D)

...Musa.

Terrified. But the fight is over.

Sezen is just sitting there. Davut's body in her arms.

She looks up. Eye contact. *He saw everything.*

BUZZ BUZZ

She checks her pockets. Then realizes: it's Davut's phone.

INT. JFK AIRPORT - NIGHT

Kaan waits in line for Turkish Airlines desk. Calling Davut. Finally, the call is answered.

KAAN

Baba. I'm on my way home.

No response. But Kaan can hear the WIND rustling through the leaves and branches. The sound of the grove. It settles him.

KAAN

We can fix this.

SEZEN (PHONE)

No. We can't.

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - DAWN

Sezen hangs up Davut's phone.

Then holds him tight in her lap.

His blood dried into the roots of the trees.

The tree rustles in response...

...and for the first time this year...

...the branches seem to grow.

HOWLING in the distance--

CUT TO BLACK.